David Van Dijcke

Assistant Professor of Economics

University of Virginia

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Academic Appointments

University of Virginia 2026 – Present
Assistant Professor of Economics Charlottesville, VA

Education

University of Michigan Aug 2026
PhD, Economics Ann Arbor, MI

- Dissertation: *Distributions & Discontinuities: Nonparametric Methods for Heterogeneous Threshold Effects in Economics*.
- Visiting Research Student Collaborator, Princeton University (Mar 2024). Sponsor: Prof. Ulrich K. Müller.

University of Michigan Aug 2020 – May 2022
MA, Economics Ann Arbor, MI

University of Oxford Oct 2019 – Aug 2020
Probationer Research Student, Economics Oxford, UK

KU Leuven Sep 2016 – Jul 2019
MSc Economics; MSc Economic Policy; BA Philosophy Leuven, Belgium

- **MSc Economics** (*Magna cum laude*, 83%): dissertation awarded Best Student Paper (2018–19).
- **MSc Economic Policy** (*Summa cum laude*, 85.77%).
- **BA Philosophy** (*Magna cum laude*, 81.57%).

Royal Academy of Fine Arts / Ghent University Sep 2013 – Jul 2016
BA, Theatre (Cum laude) Ghent, Belgium

Research Fields

Econometrics; Applied Microeconomics

Publications and Forthcoming

1. Blair, C. W., Van Dijcke, D., & Wright, A. L. (2025). Refugee return and conflict: Evidence from a natural experiment [Forthcoming]. *American Economic Review*
2. Van Dijcke, D., Gunsilius, F., & Wright, A. L. (2024). Return to office and the tenure distribution [Forthcoming]. *The Review of Economics and Statistics*
3. Gunsilius, F., & Van Dijcke, D. (2025). disco: Distributional synthetic controls [Forthcoming]. *The Stata Journal*
4. Van Dijcke, D., Wright, A. L., & Polyak, M. (2023). Public response to government alerts saves lives during Russian invasion of Ukraine. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences*
5. Milosh, M., Painter, M., Sonin, K., Van Dijcke, D., & Wright, A. L. (2021). Unmasking partisanship: Polarization undermines public response to collective risk. *Journal of Public Economics*
6. Brzezinski, A., Kecht, V., Van Dijcke, D., & Wright, A. L. (2021). Science skepticism reduced compliance with COVID-19 shelter-in-place policies in the United States. *Nature Human Behaviour*, *5*(11), 1519–1527

7. Brzezinski, A., Deiana, G., Kecht, V., & Van Dijcke, D. (2020). The COVID-19 pandemic: Government vs. community action across the United States. *Covid Economics: Vetted and Real-Time Papers*, *7*, 115–156
8. Van Dijcke, D. (2018). The impact of ECB unconventional monetary policy on income inequality in the Netherlands. *Bank en Financiewezen*, *3*

Working Papers

1. Van Dijcke, D. (2025a). Regression discontinuity design with distribution-valued outcomes. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2504.03992*
2. Van Dijcke, D. (2025b). A test for jumps in metric-space conditional means [Under review]. *arXiv preprint arXiv:2507.04560*
3. Gunsilius, F., & Van Dijcke, D. (2024). Free discontinuity regression [Under review]
4. Van Dijcke, D. (2023). On the non-identification of revenue production functions [Under review]. *Bank of England Staff Working Papers*, *1015*
5. Van Dijcke, D., Buckmann, M., Turrell, A., & Key, T. (2023). Vacancy posting, firm balance sheets and government interventions during the COVID-19 pandemic [Under review]. *Bank of England Staff Working Papers*
6. Sonin, K., Van Dijcke, D., & Wright, A. L. (2023). Isolation and insurrection: How partisanship and political geography fueled January 6, 2021 [Under review]. *University of Chicago, Becker Friedman Institute for Economics Working Paper*, (2021-13)
7. Van Dijcke, D., & Wright, A. L. (2020). Using mobile device traces to improve near-real time data collection during the george floyd protests [Research note]. *Available at SSRN 3621731*
8. Lewis, V., & Van Dijcke, D. (2019). Work effort and the cycle: Evidence from survey data [Under review]. *Deutsche Bundesbank Discussion Papers*

Fellowships and Awards

- Best Student Paper Award, Midwestern Econometrics Group (MEG) Conference (2025)
- Lawrence Klein Fellowship in Econometrics, University of Michigan (2025)
- Rackham Predoctoral Fellowship, University of Michigan (2024–25)
- WU Best Paper Award, City of Vienna (2022)
- Honorary Fellow, Belgian American Educational Foundation (2020–21)
- Pinxten Award, Best MSc Economics Paper, KU Leuven (2019)

Teaching Experience

University of Virginia Fall 2026
Instructor Charlottesville, VA

– ECON 3720: Introduction to Econometrics

Harris School of Public Policy, University of Chicago Oct–Nov 2024; Nov 2025
Teaching Fellow Riyadh, Saudi Arabia

– 2025: Main Lecturer for Economic Data & Modeling (2-week intensive course for Saudi government training program)
– 2024: Main Lecturer for Applied Econometrics (3-week program). 100% student satisfaction on evaluations.

University of Michigan Aug 2021 – Dec 2024
Graduate Student Instructor Ann Arbor, MI

– Graduate Courses: Applied Microeconometrics (Fall 2024), Intro to Econometric Analysis I (Winter 2023)
– Undergraduate Courses: Intermediate Statistics & Econometrics I (Fall 2021–Spring 2022)

Other Professional Experience

Bank of England May 2020 – Present
Academic Visitor; former PhD Intern London, UK

- Research and policy analysis using big data on UK labor markets and the COVID-19 economy; results presented to the Monetary Policy Committee and published as two Staff Working Papers.

Ipsos Public Affairs, LLC Mar 2022 – May 2024
Consulting Analyst, Risk Analytics Washington, DC

- Geospatial analyst for UN/World Bank post-disaster assessments (Gaza, Nepal, Afghanistan, Syria); findings cited by *Reuters* and other global outlets.
- Built interactive real-time mobility monitoring app for FIFA World Cup 2022.
- Integrated SAR imagery, mobile device data, and surveys for conflict/disaster impact analysis.

Deutsche Bundesbank June–Aug 2019
Research Intern Frankfurt, DE

Presentations and Seminars

2027 Econometric Society North American Winter Meetings, Washington, DC. **2026** Midwest Econometrics Group Annual Meeting, University of Cincinnati; Rutgers Economics; Microeconometrics Class of 2026 Conference, Duke; UNC Chapel Hill Economics; Econometric Society North American Summer Meetings, Atlanta; Georgia State Economics; CEMFI Economics; Ohio State Economics; University of Virginia Economics; Bocconi Economics; Erasmus University Rotterdam Econometrics; IIES Stockholm; UPF Barcelona Economics; Queensland University Economics (virtual); University of Oxford Economics; University of Copenhagen Economics; ASSA Annual Meetings – AEA session, Philadelphia (poster); Econometric Society North American Winter Meetings, Philadelphia. **2025** Midwestern Econometrics Seminar, Emory University; New Methods Seminar, Bank of England; EEA Congress, Bordeaux School of Economics; Econometrics Seminar, University of Copenhagen; Midwestern Econometrics Meeting, UIUC; Economics Graduate Student Conference, Washington University in St. Louis; Southern Economic Association Annual Conference, Florida. **2024** Michigan IO-Econometrics Workshop, University of Michigan; Remote Work Conference, Stanford University; New Connections in the Study of Political Economy, Panama; ESIF Economics and AI+ML Meeting, Cornell University; ASSA 2024, San Antonio. **2023** Econometric Society European Winter Meeting 2023, University of Manchester; Econometric Society North America Summer Meeting 2023, UCLA; New Methods Seminar, Bank of England; ASSA 2023, New Orleans; Dewey Data Research Seminars; Ipsos Center for Analytics Excellence. **2022** EEA-ESAM Congress, Bocconi University; Econometric Society Australasia Meeting; ESCoE Conference on Economic Measurement, University of Strathclyde; Bank of England. **2021** NBER Summer Institute 2021, National Security Session; Bank of England; Indeed Policy Partners Workshop. **2020** Banca d'Italia and Federal Reserve Board Joint Conference on Nontraditional Data & Statistical Learning; SafeGraph Data Consortium.

Professional Service

Refereeing: Nature Communications; Journal of Business & Economic Statistics; The Economic Journal; Quantitative Economics; Journal of the Royal Statistical Society Series B; Journal of Public Economics; Journal of the European Economic Association; Harvard Kennedy School Misinformation Review; Applied Economics Letters.

Software

1. `coarse!`: Open-source, not-for-profit AI academic reviewer – https://www.coarse.ink
2. `R3D` (R): Regression Discontinuity with Distribution-Valued Outcomes – https://www.davidvandijcke.com/R3D/
3. `frechesTest` (R): Test for Jumps in Metric-Space Conditional Means – https://github.com/Davidvandijcke/frechesTest
4. `DiSCos` (R, Stata): Distributional Synthetic Controls – https://www.davidvandijcke.com/DiSCos/

Skills and Languages

Programming and software: Python, R, Stata, MATLAB, C++, Fortran, SQL; PyTorch; ArcGIS/GeoPandas; Spark/PySpark; AWS/BigQuery; Git; Linux; LaTeX
Languages: Dutch (native), English (advanced), French (advanced), German (intermediate)